

AutoPulse.ai

New Lead Follow-Up & Appointment Workflow

Developer Implementation Specification | Version 1 | September 2026

Core operating principle

Every new sales lead remains actively worked until contact produces a defined next action, an appointment, an opt-out/suppression event, a Sales Visit, or the opportunity reaches Day 91. Bucket-specific qualification logic may differ, but this state machine applies regardless of lead bucket.

Compliance: Every automated SMS/email/AI action and human call task remains subordinate to AutoPulse communication-permission, opt-out, dealer schedule, time-window, frequency, and suppression guardrails.

1. State Machine Overview

Status	Trigger	Workflow / exit
New Lead	New lead received.	Immediately enters Short-Term Follow-Up.
No Contact Made	No meaningful two-way contact.	Short-Term Follow-Up.
Contact Made - No Next Action	Contact occurred, but no appointment or dated next action exists.	Short-Term Follow-Up.
Contact Made - Specific Follow-Up	Customer has a defined future next action.	Specific Follow-Up; date/time/channel/context required.
Appointment Set	Valid appointment created by AI or human.	Appointment Follow-Up.
Appointment No Show	Appointment time + 1 hour; no qualifying Sales Visit.	Appointment No-Show Follow-Up.
Sales Visit	Customer logged into dealership SALES.	Stop lead/appointment flows; require manager outcome: SOLD PENDING, SOLD DELIVERED, or UNSOLD.
Opted Out / Suppressed	Applicable revocation or suppression event.	Immediately stop prohibited channels/tasks.
Opportunity Closed - No Response	Day 91 reached without superseding business outcome.	Close opportunity; retain customer record/history.

2. Global Transition Rules

- **One controlling workflow:** a customer/opportunity cannot simultaneously run incompatible Short-Term, Specific Follow-Up, Appointment, and No-Show flows.
- **Status change cancels stale work:** cancel/pause future messages and human tasks from the prior status before starting the new workflow.
- **Appointment wins:** any appointment creation immediately sets Appointment Set.
- **Sales Visit wins:** any qualifying SALES check-in immediately sets Sales Visit and stops lead/appointment/no-show automation.
- **Specific timing wins:** 'call me Friday/next month/in a year' creates a dated future action rather than continuing aggressive Short-Term cadence.
- **Opt-out wins:** immediately suppress the affected communication(s) under the compliance policy.
- **Master opportunity age never resets:** re-entry may restart a cadence instance, but original opportunity_created_at continues toward Day 91.
- **Pre-send recheck:** immediately before any queued message/task executes, re-read current status, reply state, appointment state, Sales Visit state, suppression state, and compliance result.

3. Short-Term Follow-Up

Triggers: New Lead, No Contact Made, Contact Made - No Next Action, and completion of the defined Appointment No-Show sequence.

Days 1-7: Day 1 has Touch 1 plus the mandatory three-hour Touch 2. Days 2-7 have one additional SMS + email touch per day. Human agents receive two call tasks per scheduled workday for seven days.

Touch	Timing	Theme	Required behavior
1	Immediately / eligible window	Quality lead response	Answer actual lead question(s); identify agent/dealer/location/vehicle; ALWAYS end: 'Tell me, what are you driving now?'
2	3 hours later; next eligible window if blocked	Mandatory name nudge	{FirstName}? This is non-negotiable; do not replace with other sales copy.
3	Day 2	Vehicle visual	Send useful vehicle photo and a simple vehicle-related question.
4	Day 3	Financing help	Ask whether the customer needs help with financing/payment options; do not invent terms or approval.
5	Day 4	Trade-in	Ask about trade/appraisal using known context; never repeat an already-answered question.
6	Day 5	Vehicle value/feature	Highlight a relevant verified feature, trim detail, use case, or vehicle fact; photo when useful.
7	Day 6	Appointment value	Give a truthful reason to visit: appraisal, comparison, financing review, management review, or right-team meeting; ask for appointment.
8	Day 7	Direct close	Ask if still considering vehicle and offer practical appointment options / ask what day works.

Touch 1 required structure

Hello {customer_first_name}, this is {agent_name} from {dealership_name} in {city}, {state}. Thank you for your interest in our {vehicle_year} {vehicle_model}. I am excited to help you with your purchase.
 {AI_BEST_ANSWER_TO_LEAD_QUESTIONS} Tell me, what are you driving now?

AI must read the full lead first. Address questions/requests accurately before the mandatory final question. Never fabricate availability, pricing, financing, promotions, vehicle facts, or dealer policy.

Touch 2: if there is no response after three hours, send {FirstName}?. If outside the permitted communication window, queue it for the next permitted time.

Human call tasks - Days 1-7

Behavior	Requirement
Morning	Create/surface call task during assigned agent's scheduled hours; Click-to-Call where available.
Afternoon	Create second call task only if lead still has an eligible Short-Term status.
Completion	Agent marks completed or Click-to-Call completion is captured.
Outcome prompt	Immediately require outcome/status selection after call.
Appointment	Appointment creation automatically sets Appointment Set.
Specific follow-up	Require next action date, time, channel, owner, and context.
No contact	Remain No Contact Made / Short-Term.
Contact, no action	Set Contact Made - No Next Action.

Behavior	Requirement
Status changed first	Cancel obsolete call task.

4. Days 8-90 Extended Cadence

Period	Cadence	Guidance
Days 8-30	1 outreach cycle/week via SMS + email	Fresh relevant angle: vehicle/photo, financing help, trade, verified inventory/trim information, verified price change/OEM offer, appointment invitation.
Days 31-90	1 outreach cycle/month via SMS + email	Verified price/OEM changes, relevant inventory, trade/equity, financing help, or renewed appointment invitation.
Day 91	End active-opportunity cadence	Customer remains open in CRM/customer base; opportunity closes; preserve history.

AI selection rule: before each touch, read the full lead, conversation, notes, prior questions, known vehicle/trade information, and available current inventory/promotion data. Choose the most relevant unused angle instead of blindly rotating templates.

5. Response Router

Event	Transition
Reply + appointment created	Appointment Set -> Appointment Follow-Up.
Reply + no appointment + no dated next action	Contact Made - No Next Action -> Short-Term Follow-Up.
Reply + clear future timing	Contact Made - Specific Follow-Up.
'Not ready' + week/month/year horizon	Create future next action; Specific/Future Follow-Up.
Applicable opt-out	Suppress affected channel(s); stop prohibited outreach.
Sales check-in	Sales Visit -> manager outcome required.
No response	Continue eligible cadence until transition or Day 91.

6. Contact Made - Specific Follow-Up

Entry requires structured next-action data so neither AI nor human intent is lost.

Field	Rule
next_action_date	Required.
next_action_time	Required if known; otherwise dealer-configurable approved default/selection rule.
next_action_channel	Call, SMS, email, or approved combination.
next_action_owner	AI or human.
context_notes	What customer requested/what should happen next.
entered_by + timestamp	Required audit fields.

At the scheduled action, AI/human follows the actual notes/conversation. The appointment remains the goal. If the scheduled follow-up is executed and there is **no response within 24 hours**, set **No Contact Made** and enter Short-Term Follow-Up. Appointment -> Appointment Set. Opt-out -> suppression.

Long-horizon rule: a future customer task may survive beyond Day 91 even though the current opportunity closes. The future task belongs to the customer relationship; when due, business logic may create/reopen a new opportunity rather than keeping the original opportunity artificially open.

7. Appointment Set Workflow

When	Action
15 minutes after set	Text + email current appointment information, allowing time for correction.
Each day before appointment (not same-day)	Send a different vehicle photo + 'Counting down to our meeting at {dealership_name}!'
Day before	Text + email: 'Hello, {customer_first_name}, this is {agent_name} at {dealership_name} confirming our meeting for {date} at {time}. Does this time still work? Please reply Y for Yes or N for No.'
Confirmed by AI/human	Set appointment.confirmed = true; update appointment report.
Appointment + 1 hour; no Sales Visit	Set Appointment No Show -> No-Show workflow.
Sales Visit on appointment date	Set Sales Visit; mark appointment.showed = true and update report regardless of arrival time.

15-minute appointment message

{customer_first_name}, we are all set to meet on {appointment_date} at {appointment_time} at {dealership_name}, {dealership_address}. Please make sure to call or text us if anything changes at {ai_agent_phone}. Looking forward to assisting you!

Same-day appointment: send the 15-minute details when still useful, but skip daily pre-appointment countdown/photo messages and any nonsensical day-before confirmation.

8. Appointment Confirmation Router

Response	Action
Y / clear yes	Mark Confirmed; keep Appointment Set active.
N / clear no	Do not mark confirmed. Immediately attempt reschedule; capture new date/time.
Ambiguous	Seek clarification; do not mark confirmed until clear.
No response	Remain scheduled but unconfirmed; normal appointment/no-show logic continues.
Human phone confirmation	Human marks Confirmed; report updates.
Reschedule	Update appointment, cancel old confirmation/no-show timers, and schedule against new appointment time.

9. Appointment No-Show Workflow

Step	Timing	Action
1	At +1 hour No Show trigger	SMS + email + vehicle photo: 'Hello, this is {agent_name} with {dealership_name}. I am looking for you in the showroom - are you here and working with someone?'
2	24 hours later if no reply	SMS + email: 'Hi! This is {agent_name} at {dealership_name} regarding your {model} purchase. How did everything go when you came in? Did you get a chance to stop by?'
3	No response after Step 2 window	Per requested rule: set Contact Made - No Next Action -> Short-Term Follow-Up.
Any time	Sales Visit logged	Stop No-Show flow; set Sales Visit; if visit is on appointment date, mark Showed.

Terminology note: routing a never-reached no-show customer to 'Contact Made - No Next Action' is technically workable but semantically inconsistent. If the status names are meant literally, **No Contact Made** is cleaner. The current specification preserves your requested behavior and flags this for final product decision.

10. Sales Visit Trigger

Rule	Behavior
Status	Set Sales Visit immediately.
Automation	Stop Short-Term, Specific, Appointment, and No-Show follow-up.
Showed logic	If an appointment exists for that calendar day, mark Showed even if arrival time differs.
Report	Update Showed immediately.
Manager outcome	Require SOLD PENDING, SOLD DELIVERED, or UNSOLD.
Next workflow	Defined in separate Sales Visit workflow specification.

11. Event Priority / Race-Condition Control

Recommended priority:

1. OPT-OUT / COMPLIANCE BLOCK 2. SALES VISIT 3. APPOINTMENT SET / UPDATED 4. CONTACT MADE - SPECIFIC FOLLOW-UP 5. APPOINTMENT NO SHOW 6. CONTACT MADE - NO NEXT ACTION 7. NO CONTACT MADE 8. NEW LEAD

Before any queued action fires, query current state. Never execute a task simply because it was previously placed in a queue.

12. Opportunity Clock

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opportunity_created_at = immutable original timestamp
opportunity_age_days = now - opportunity_created_at
workflow_entered_at = current workflow entry timestamp
short_term_cycle_day = cadence day within current instance
last_meaningful_contact_at = timestamp/null
last_outbound_at = timestamp/null
next_action_at = timestamp/null
opportunity_closed_at = null until closure

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Re-entry into Short-Term may restart the cadence instance, but **never reset opportunity_created_at**. Day 91 closes the

Required business rule:

Appointment No Show + not rescheduled -> Contact Made - No Next Action -> Short-Term Follow-Up. This is intentional AutoPulse workflow logic and must not be changed to No Contact Made.

- Use customer responses/context to move toward the next best action and appointment.
- Never fabricate availability, price, incentives, financing approval/terms, vehicle facts, photos, OEM programs, or dealer policy.
- Only use verified current price changes/OEM promotions.
- Vehicle photos must come from an authorized inventory/media source for the intended vehicle or approved alternative.
- Vary follow-up angles and avoid repetitive messages.
- Every send still requires current status and compliance authorization.

14. Recommended Events

LEAD_CREATED OUTBOUND_SENT CUSTOMER_REPLIED CALL_COMPLETED CALL_OUTCOME_SELECTED NEXT_ACTION_SET
 APPOINTMENT_CREATED APPOINTMENT_UPDATED APPOINTMENT_CONFIRMED APPOINTMENT_TIME_PASSED SALES_VISIT_CREATED
 OPT_OUT_RECEIVED COMPLIANCE_BLOCKED STATUS_CHANGED OPPORTUNITY_DAY_91_REACHED

15. Missing Edge Cases to Lock Down

Item	Recommended implementation
Wrong person / bad number	Add data-quality/suppression outcome; never continue known-wrong-number outreach.
Hard-bounce email	Suppress invalid email after provider-defined hard bounce; other permitted channels may continue.
Duplicate lead	Link/merge to existing active customer/opportunity; prevent duplicate simultaneous workflows.
Appointment cancellation	Attempt reschedule; if no replacement appointment/detailed next action, route to Contact Made - No Next Action.
Rescheduled appointment	Cancel old confirmation/no-show timers; use new appointment time.
Multiple appointments	Default to one active primary sales appointment per opportunity unless explicitly allowed.
Photo unavailable	Never fabricate/unrelated photo; use approved alternate media or a non-photo message.
No exact time for future follow-up	Require selection or dealer-configurable compliant default.
Channel-specific opt-out	Track SMS/email/call suppression separately plus broader 'do not contact' requests under compliance policy.
Short-Term re-entry	Restart cadence only as intended; preserve Day-91 clock and prevent duplicate same-day touches.
Long-horizon follow-up	Keep future customer task after Day 91; close original opportunity and create/reopen opportunity when future action becomes due, per final business rule.

16. Developer Acceptance Tests

- New lead creates exactly one Short-Term workflow regardless of bucket.
- Touch 1 answers lead questions and ends with 'what are you driving now?'
- Touch 2 is the first-name question nudge at 3 hours or next permitted window.
- Two human call tasks occur only on scheduled workdays while status remains eligible.
- Customer reply prevents stale queued AI messages from firing.
- Appointment creation stops Short-Term/Specific flow and starts Appointment Follow-Up.

- Confirmation updates appointment and report.
- Sales Visit on appointment date marks Showed regardless of exact arrival time.
- Rescheduled/old appointment cannot create a false No Show.
- No Show begins only at appointment + 1 hour with no Sales Visit.
- Specific Follow-Up with no response after 24 hours routes to No Contact Made.
- Opt-out prevents prohibited queued communications.
- Short-Term re-entry does not reset opportunity_created_at.
- Day 91 closes opportunity while retaining customer/history/future customer task where applicable.
- No customer has conflicting active workflow instances.

17. Next Workflow Specification

Next document begins at **Sales Visit** and defines the required manager outcomes **SOLD PENDING, SOLD DELIVERED, and UNSOLD**, including automation, human tasks, reporting, delivery logic, opportunity close/reopen rules, and follow-up for each.

Global Human Call Task Escalation Rule

Required addition to all AutoPulse follow-up workflows in this specification

NON-NEGOTIABLE GLOBAL RULE

Every time AutoPulse schedules an automated text/email follow-up touch, the system must also schedule a human call-task checkpoint for 1 hour after that AI touch.

If meaningful customer contact occurs before the 1-hour checkpoint, cancel the call task.

If no meaningful contact occurs, create/activate the human call task.

Required Developer Logic

1. AI SMS/email touch is successfully sent.
2. Start a 60-minute connection timer tied to that specific outreach event.
3. During the 60 minutes, watch for meaningful customer contact by AI or human.
4. If meaningful contact occurs, cancel the pending call task.
5. If no meaningful contact occurs at 60 minutes, create/activate a human call task.
6. Call task must identify the customer, vehicle/opportunity, last AI touch, and current status.
7. Human can Click-to-Call where available or mark the call completed manually.
8. After call completion, immediately prompt the human for the required AutoPulse outcome/status.
9. If the call produces an appointment, Appointment Set is applied automatically and its workflow starts.
10. If the call produces a specific future action, enter Contact Made - Specific Follow-Up.
11. If contact occurs but no clear next action exists, enter Contact Made - No Next Action.
12. If there is no contact, remain in the applicable no-contact/follow-up workflow.
13. If the customer opts out, apply the appropriate suppression immediately.

Where This Rule Applies

- Days 1-7 Short-Term Follow-Up AI text/email touches.
- Weekly Days 8-30 text/email outreach.
- Monthly Days 31-90 text/email outreach.
- Contact Made - Specific Follow-Up when the AI sends the scheduled text/email.
- Appointment and Appointment No-Show text/email touches when human follow-up is appropriate.

Important scheduling guardrail

The 1-hour human call task must also respect the human agent's scheduled work hours/days and the applicable communication/compliance rules. If the 1-hour checkpoint falls outside an allowed calling period or the agent's schedule, move the task to the next eligible call window. Before activating the task, re-check current status so stale call tasks do not fire after a reply, appointment, Sales Visit, opt-out, or other workflow-changing event.

Global Omnichannel Follow-Up Rule

Required controlling rule for every follow-up workflow in this specification

NON-NEGOTIABLE: ALL FOLLOW-UP = CALL + TEXT + EMAIL

Whenever a follow-up is due, AutoPulse must engage all available permitted channels: AI text + AI email + human call task. Call, text, and email are not optional alternatives unless a channel is unavailable, invalid, suppressed, or legally blocked.

Standard Follow-Up Sequence

1. At the scheduled follow-up time, AI sends the contextually appropriate SMS and email.
2. Start a 60-minute connection timer after the outbound AI touch.
3. If meaningful customer contact occurs during that hour, cancel the pending human call task.
4. If no meaningful connection occurs after 60 minutes, activate the human call task.
5. The call task supports Click-to-Call where available and requires completion plus outcome.
6. Appointment -> Appointment Set. Defined future action -> Contact Made - Specific Follow-Up.
7. Contact without clear next action -> Contact Made - No Next Action. No contact -> remain in applicable flow.
8. Opt-out/suppression immediately removes any prohibited channel from future touches.

Applies Everywhere Follow-Up Occurs

- Days 1-7 Short-Term Follow-Up
- Days 8-30 weekly follow-up
- Days 31-90 monthly follow-up
- Contact Made - Specific Follow-Up
- Appointment follow-up and confirmation touches
- Appointment No-Show follow-up
- Any later workflow that calls for customer follow-up unless that workflow explicitly stops outreach

Channel Availability & Compliance

'All channels' means all channels valid and permitted for that customer at that moment. If SMS is opted out, do not text. If email is invalid/unsubscribed, do not email. If calling is blocked or outside the eligible window, do not call then. Continue every remaining permitted channel.

Developer Override Rule

This omnichannel rule supersedes earlier wording in this PDF that describes follow-up as 'call/text/email,' 'text/email,' or a choice among channels. For implementation, every follow-up means CALL + TEXT + EMAIL, subject only to current status, connection state, valid channel data, suppression/opt-out, scheduling, and the AutoPulse compliance engine.